
LECTURE NOTES

Lecture 5: Communication

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April - 2026



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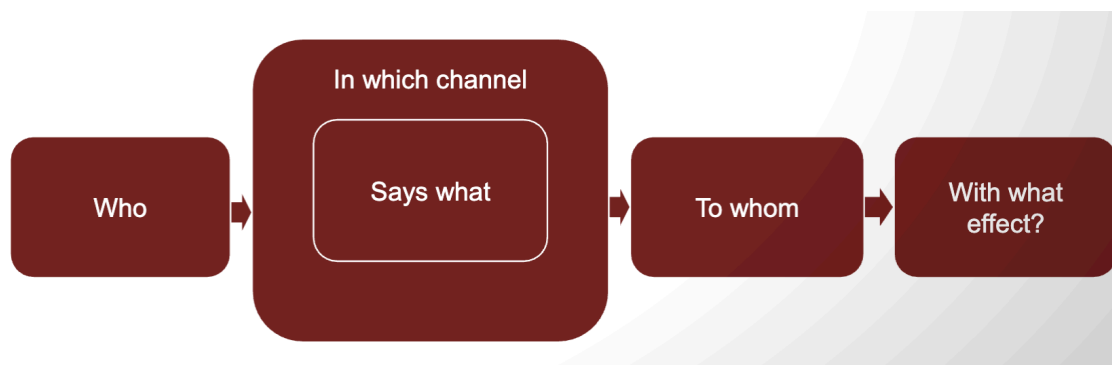
1 What is communication

- Inevitable
 - one cannot **not** communicate
- Episodic
 - Describing when communication starts is like an attempt to photograph dancing: we typically make a

somewhat arbitrary cut in analysing communication episodes

- Constructed
 - verbal & non-verbal symbols and signs
 - both by the sender and the recipient
- Contextual
 - Interpretation of communication is influenced by multiple contexts
 - both the communication itself and cultural context

1.1 Communication as a process



1.2 Multiple levels of communication

- One-to-many
 - Mass communication
 - Public communication to an audience
- Many-to-many
 - Group communication
- One-to-one
 - Interpersonal communication
- In your head
 - Intrapersonal communication

2 How do we speak

- Speaking takes up to 5 times longer to generate a word compared to recognizing it
- Speaking always requires intention (working memory & system 2 thinking)

- Word recognition becomes often automatic
- Writing is also typically intentional

2.1 Speaking stages

- 1) Conceptualization
 - interface between thinking and language production
- 2) Formulation
 - propositions and concepts are represented as lemmas or lexical entries
- 3) Phonological encoding
 - the lemmas are encoded in actual grammatical structure
- 4) articulation
 - muscles are activated and speaking occurs

Because of all this (very exhausting), speech is shortened a lot and contextualized to save energy

3 Language and social context

Central for successful communication: a common ground in the respective context

- Shared beliefs
- Shared assumptions
- Shared Knowledge 🧐

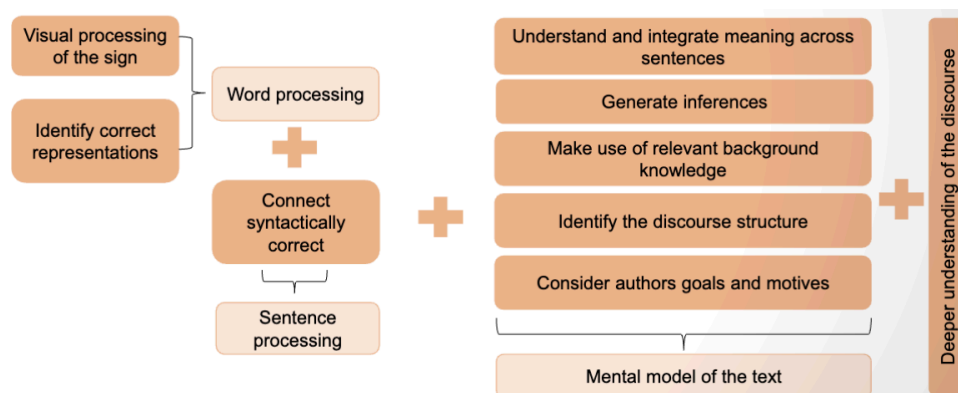
Good communicators would estimate these correctly and they adapt to it

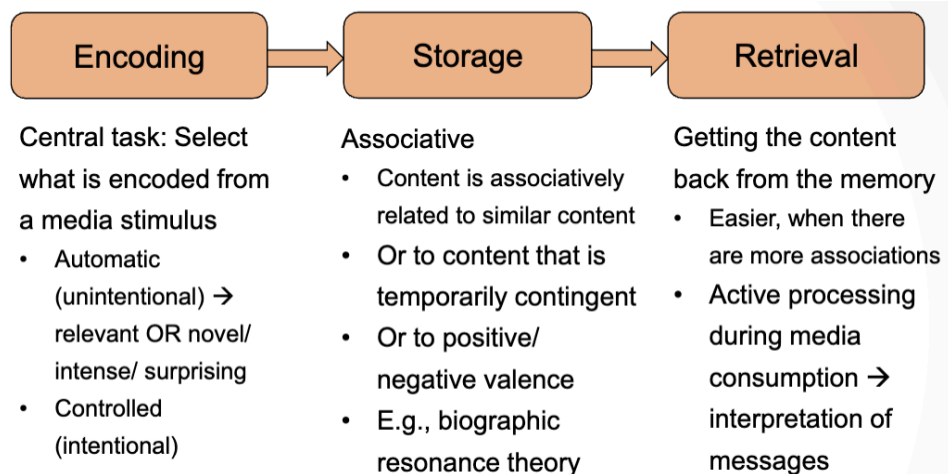
Common ground emerges from two sources:

- Communal common ground (= community/ culture based)
- Personal common ground (= participants shared experiences)

4 Processing communication

4.1 Perception





4.2 Computer-mediated communication

Can differ from face-to-face communication

- Synchronicity
- Permanency • Anonymity • Less cues (e.g., lack of nonverbal communication) • Other cues (e.g., emojis)

4.3 Media richness theory

Basic idea: Match the richness of the chosen communication medium to the significance of reducing uncertainty and establishing equivocality

- Richness
 - immediate feedback, multiple cues, language variety, personal focus

5 The Social Identity Deindividuation Effects Model (SIDE)

- In anonymous digital contexts, our personal identity is less important
- Instead: Stronger orientation towards the norms in the respective digital context
 - We adapt to the norms of communication
- If the norms are hostile: More hostile behaviour
- If the norms are constructive: More constructive behaviour